NovaCart Support Playbook: Shipping & Delivery

Category: Shipping & Delivery | **Document ID:** SOP-OPS-SD-01 | **Version:** 2026.4 | **Scope:** Tier 1-3 Support

Section 1: Order Ingestion, Fulfillment Channels & Status Topology

1.1 Operational Framework: This Standard Operating Procedure defines operational workflows for handling domestic and international shipping, transit tracking, and logistics fulfillment across NovaCart's multi-category e-commerce network. Customer Service Representatives (CSRs) must adhere to these directives to ensure maximum First-Contact Resolution (FCR) while mitigating merchant loss and carrier chargeback liabilities.

1.2 Fulfillment Channel Architecture

- **Fulfilled by NovaCart (FBN):** Consignments stored, picked, packed, and dispatched directly from automated NovaCart fulfillment centers. Dispatched via tier-1 contract carriers with automated tracking webhooks updating every 15 minutes.
- **Direct Merchant Fulfillment (DMF):** Third-party marketplace sellers inventory and fulfill orders independently. SLA mandates dispatch manifest generation within 48 business hours from placement.
- **Heavy & Bulky Surface Network (HBN):** White-glove two-man logistics for appliances, gym machines, and furniture exceeding 30 kg, featuring scheduled delivery appointment windows.

1.3 Internal WMS vs. Customer-Facing Status Taxonomy

WMS Code	App Status	Technical Definition	Mandatory Agent Protocol
`ALLOCATED`	Preparing Order	Order routed to warehouse cluster; wave picking initiated.	Inform customer order is within preparation SLA. No manual cancels.
`MANIFEST_OK`	Ready for Pickup	Shipping label printed, bill of lading assigned, awaiting truck dock scan.	Verify carrier AWB. If aged >24h without pickup scan, flag warehouse.
`IN_TRANSIT`	On the Way	Consignment scanned into line-haul network or intermediate sorting hub.	Reassure delivery is on schedule. Review milestone scan history.
`OFD_ASSIGNED`	Out for Delivery	Package loaded into Last Mile Delivery Executive (LMDE) van/bike.	Provide direct carrier delivery PIN/OTP. Check driver contact route.

> ***Critical Compliance Rule:*** *Never advise a customer that a package is lost or offer financial compensation while the internal status remains `IN_TRANSIT` and the package is still within the Promised Estimated Delivery Date (EDD).*

Section 2: In-Transit Stalls, Weather Bottlenecks & Address Modifications

2.1 Diagnostic Protocols for Stalled Consignments: A shipment is technically classified as 'Stalled in Transit' when no electronic movement scan is recorded for 36 consecutive hours for air shipments, or 60 hours for surface ground shipments.

2.2 Carrier Tracing and Internal SLA Triggers

- **Stage 1 (Hour 36-48):** Initiate electronic tracer via Carrier Integration Gateway API. System issues an automated inquiry to the originating hub scan supervisor.
- **Stage 2 (Hour 48-72):** Escalate to Tier-2 Logistics Liaison. CSR places CRM ticket in `Pending Logistics Partner Investigation`. Automated SMS alert sent to customer advising of active route verification.
- **Stage 3 (Hour 72+):** If no physical package location is established by carrier dispatch within 72 hours, classify as Presumed Lost (refer to Section 4).

2.3 Mid-Transit Destination Amendments

Current Status	Permitted Modifications	System Mechanism	Expected SLA
Pre-Manifest	Full address, ZIP code, recipient name, phone.	Order Management Console (OMS) Edit	Instantaneous
In-Transit Linehaul	Landmark details, recipient contact phone, gate code.	Carrier API Intercept Dispatch	4 to 6 Business Hours
Out for Delivery	Driver delivery note instructions only.	LMDE Direct Dispatch Broadcast	Immediate / Real-time
Different Postal Code	Prohibited mid-transit due to state sales tax jurisdictions.	RTO Initiation & Order Re-order	Requires re-purchase

> ***Interstate Tax Note:*** *Modifying delivery addresses across state lines post-dispatch is legally barred due to statutory interstate invoicing and GST/VAT remittance requirements.*

Section 3: Delivery Exceptions, Non-Delivery Reports & False Deliveries

3.1 Non-Delivery Report (NDR) Management: When an LMDE fails to complete delivery, an automated NDR code is registered. NovaCart enforces a strict 3-attempt cycle prior to initiating Return to Origin (RTO).

3.2 Resolution Protocols for Primary NDR Codes

- **NDR-01 (Customer Unavailable / Door Closed):** Cross-check carrier telecom log. Carrier app must show a minimum of two automated outbound voice calls placed to the registered customer number within 15 minutes of arrival.
- **NDR-02 (Incomplete / Inaccurate Address):** CSR must immediately contact customer via outbound dial or chat to capture landmark coordinates, apartment building names, or access gate instructions, updating carrier manifest notes.
- **NDR-03 (Customer Refused Delivery):** Determine if refusal was due to visible package tampering or buyer remorse. If outer box shows structural puncture, instruct carrier to return without penalty to customer.

3.3 'Marked Delivered But Not Received' (False Delivery) Triage

Verification Stage	Tool / Evidence Required	Audit Standard	Remediation Step
Immediate (0-2h)	Perimeter Survey Check	Verify mailrooms, front desks, building concierges.	Customer self-service verification guide.
Digital Audit (2-6h)	Proof of Delivery (POD) Image	Review recipient signature & digital timestamp.	Match signed name with authorized household members.
Geofence Audit	GPS Ping Metadata vs Geocodes	Carrier van ping must be within 50m of delivery pin.	If >150m variance detected, flag carrier fault immediately.
Driver Interview	Carrier Station Dispatch Log	Driver debriefed by local hub station manager.	Carrier given 12h SLA to recover parcel or declare lost.

Section 4: Lost Shipments, Replacement Dispatches & Resolution Matrices

4.1 Declaration of Lost Consignment: A shipment is conclusively written off as Lost in Transit (LIT) when the third-party logistics carrier confirms an unrecoverable discrepancy, when geofence data confirms misdelivery to an unretrievable location, or when a stalled tracer exceeds 72 hours without physical scan.

4.2 Customer Compensation and Replacement Resolution Matrix

Category & Basket Value	Standard Customer Remedy	VIP / High-LTV Remedy	Discretionary Goodwill Credit
Apparel / FMCG (< $50)	Automated 1-click re-order dispatch or full gateway refund.	Instant wallet refund + $5 credit code issued immediately.	Up to $10 agent discretion without TL sign-off.
Consumer Electronics ($50-$300)	Immediate replacement priority dispatch via next-day air.	Immediate replacement with priority courier tracking.	Up to $20 voucher code with Team Lead sign-off.
High-Value Devices (> $300)	Mandatory 24h carrier loss confirmation prior to re-dispatch.	Fast-tracked verification call; re-shipment with OTP mandate.	Escalation to Tier-3 Operations Manager required.

4.3 Standard Customer Communication Macros

> ***Macro A (Delayed Transit Apology):*** *'Dear [Customer], thank you for contacting NovaCart. We identified a short logistical delay at our [Hub Name] regional transit hub. Your package is fully secure and moving forward. We have prioritized your delivery for [Date]. To thank you for your patience, we have credited [Amount] NovaCart Reward Points to your account.'*

> ***Macro B (False Delivery Investigation):*** *'Dear [Customer], we take delivery integrity very seriously. We have launched a priority geofence audit with carrier management to verify driver GPS logs and signature records. We will conclude this inquiry within 12 hours. If your package is unrecovered, a fresh replacement will dispatch immediately at no cost.'*